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By the way, Rinku's massive effort wasn't credited to coach Chandu (Chandrakant) Pandit by anybody last season, like all the great efforts of Kolkata this season are being suggested as the influence of the current mentor and former skipper Gautam Gambhir. Of course, Gambhir himself will be the first to acknowledge that the credit can't go to any single individual, as he has been harping on about the 2011 World Cup finals win. Pandit is still the coach too and what it indicates is that the media will invariably give the bouquet to the person who is the more famous and marketable to get the eyeballs or optics, as it's called now while those who have also had a significant role to play will hardly, if ever, get a mention.

India starts its campaign for the ICC men's T20 World Cup against Ireland. With the captain,

Turning the tide: Hopefully, this will be just the beginning of a resurgence for Yash Dayal, and other bowlers who have been taken to the cleaners this season will see that there is always light at the end of the tunnel. PTI

vice-captain and key batter and bowlers' franchise being knocked out of the IPL, these players will get some quality time with their families before they embark on the World Cup. The fact that they have been playing in the same format should be a big help, as it should not take too long for them to get back into the rhythm.

Ireland cannot be taken lightly, as indeed any team in this ultra-short format of the game. The Indian team's effort must be to win big and try to intimidate their future opponents.

Indian fans have been waiting since 2007 for another T20 World Cup win — to echo the Bangalore franchise war cry, 'Ee Saala Cup Namde'.



The fact that Indian players have been playing in the same format should be a big help at the T20 World Cup, as it should not take too long for them to get back into the rhythm.